

Board 2

North Deals

None Vul

♠ J 10 6 4 2

♥ K J 8

♦ 10 7 3

♣ K 2

♠ 9 7

♥ 4 3

♦ 8 6 5 2

♣ A 8 6 5 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A 8 5

♥ Q 10 9 6

♦ Q J 9

♣ 10 7 4

♠ K Q 3

♥ A 7 5 2

♦ A K 4

♣ Q J 9

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
	Pass	Pass	1 ♣
Pass	2 ♣	Pass	3NT
All Pass			
3NT by South			

South is to play 3NT. West leads the ♠4. East puts on the ♠A and returns the ♠8.

Winners: ♠=2 ♥=1 ♦=2 ♣=1 Total = 6

Needing three more winners you are going to have to establish the ♣ suit. You are also going to have to be lucky!

You win the second ♠ and play your ♣Q. West covers with the ♣K. What do you do next?

You **DUCK**. If you take the ♣A now you will never get back to dummy to enjoy those other ♣s. So let West have the ♣K. You win his return, (probably a ♠), and play ♣J, then ♣9 to dummy's ♣A. As long as ♣s split 3-2 you will get the three winners you need.

You were prepared to lose that ♣ finesse to East so you could establish the suit in dummy.

West's play of the ♣K may have made you want to jump up with the ♣A, but you must stick to the original play of ducking one trick.

Board 4

North Deals

None Vul

♠ K 10 8 2
 ♥ K 10 4
 ♦ 8 7 2
 ♣ K J 7

♠ 7 5 4
 ♥ A Q 8 7 5
 ♦ 9 6 3
 ♣ 8 4



♠ J 9 6
 ♥ J 9 2
 ♦ Q J 10
 ♣ 10 9 3 2

♠ A Q 3
 ♥ 6 3
 ♦ A K 5 4
 ♣ A Q 6 5

West	North	East	South
	Pass	Pass	1♦
Pass	1♥	Pass	2NT
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			
3NT by South			

South is to play 3NT. West leads the ♠2. East puts on the ♠J.

Winners: ♠=2 ♥=1 ♦=2 ♣=1 Total = 6

You need three more winners. It is possible your fourth ♦ can be established, but that needs a 3-3 split. It's also possible that the ♣ finesse will work, and also the ♥ finesse. Since you need the ♥ finesse anyway you should go ahead and try to establish the ♥s.

Win the first trick with your ♠Q and play a low ♥, ducking in dummy. East will no doubt win a cheap trick but no matter. When you next gain the lead play your other low ♥ and finesse the ♥Q. Assume this wins (if it doesn't you will be going down for sure). Play the ♥A and if both defenders follow your other 2 ♥s are good and your contract is made.

Ducking the first ♥ and finessing the second could let you wind up with no tricks at all in the ♥ suit.

But, it is your only chance to make the contract.